

Lesson 5

Material

<https://github.com/unixfile/learning-python-2026>

Today

- ▶ Sets and set operations
- ▶ Dictionaries
- ▶ Exception handling
- ▶ Reading stack traces

1 Sets

```
In : my_set = {3, 7, 'gamma', 'echo'}
```

```
In : type(my_set)
```

```
Out: set
```

- ▶ A set is an unordered collection of **unique** elements
- ▶ Sets are mutable

2 Set idiosyncrasies

```
In : fruits = {'banan', 'banan', 'melon', 'kiwi'}
```

```
In : fruits
```

```
Out: {'banan', 'melon', 'kiwi'}
```

- ▶ Duplicates are silently removed
- ▶ Elements have no guaranteed order — indexing is not possible

```
In : fruits[0]
```

```
...
```

```
TypeError: 'set' object is not subscriptable
```

3 Adding and removing

```
In : countries = {'Brasilien', 'Chile'}
```

```
In : countries.add('Bolivia')
```

```
In : countries
```

```
Out: {'Brasilien', 'Chile', 'Bolivia'}
```

```
In : countries.update({'Brasilien', 'Paraguay'})
```

```
In : countries
```

```
Out: {'Brasilien', 'Chile', 'Bolivia', 'Paraguay'}
```

```
In : countries.remove('Sverige')    # KeyError if missing
```

```
In : countries.discard('Sverige')   # silent no-op if missing
```

4 Set operations

```
In : low = {1, 2, 3, 4}
```

```
In : high = {3, 4, 5, 6}
```

```
In : low | high    # union
```

```
Out: {1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6}
```

```
In : low & high    # intersection
```

```
Out: {3, 4}
```

```
In : low ^ high    # symmetric difference
```

```
Out: {1, 2, 5, 6}
```

```
In : low - high    # difference
```

```
Out: {1, 2}
```

5 Set comprehensions

```
In : squares = {x**2 for x in range(6)}
```

```
In : squares
```

```
Out: {0, 1, 4, 9, 16, 25}
```

```
In : evens = {x for x in range(10) if x % 2 == 0}
```

```
In : evens
```

```
Out: {0, 2, 4, 6, 8}
```

- ▶ Same syntax as list comprehensions but with {}

6 Dictionaries

```
In : fruit_colors = {  
    :     'äpple':    'grön',  
    :     'banan':    'gul',  
    :     'vindruva': 'lila',  
    : }
```

```
In : type(fruit_colors)
```

```
Out: dict
```

- ▶ A dictionary stores key-value pairs
- ▶ Dictionaries are mutable and ordered (since Python 3.7)

7 Accessing values

```
In : fruit_colors['banan']
```

```
Out: 'gul'
```

```
In : fruit_colors['citron']
```

```
# KeyError!
```

```
In : fruit_colors.get('citron')
```

```
# None, no crash
```

```
In : fruit_colors.get('citron', 'okänd')
```

```
Out: 'okänd'
```

- ▶ `[]` raises `KeyError` when the key is missing
- ▶ `.get()` returns `None` (or a default) instead

8 Looping over dictionaries

```
for fruit in fruit_colors:  
    print(fruit)  
# äpple, banan, vindruva
```

```
for color in fruit_colors.values():  
    print(color)  
# grön, gul, lila
```

```
for fruit, color in fruit_colors.items():  
    print(f"{fruit}: {color}")  
# äpple: grön  
# banan: gul  
# vindruva: lila
```

9 Modifying dictionaries

```
In : fruit_colors['äpple'] = 'röd'      # update existing
```

```
In : fruit_colors['mango'] = 'orange' # add new key
```

```
In : fruit_colors.pop('banan')
```

```
Out: 'gul'
```

```
In : fruit_colors.update({'kiwi': 'grön', 'äpple': 'grön'})
```

10 Nested dictionaries

```
In : betyg = {  
    :     'Alice': {'Matte': 85, 'Kemi': 92},  
    :     'Bob':   {'Matte': 78, 'Kemi': 88},  
    : }
```

```
In : betyg['Alice']['Matte']
```

```
Out: 85
```

```
In : betyg['Bob']['Engelska'] = 87
```

11 Dictionary comprehensions

```
In : squares = {x: x**2 for x in range(5)}
```

```
In : squares
```

```
Out: {0: 0, 1: 1, 2: 4, 3: 9, 4: 16}
```

```
In : original = {'äpple': 1, 'banan': 2, 'körsbär': 3}
```

```
In : swapped = {v: k for k, v in original.items()}
```

```
In : swapped
```

```
Out: {1: 'äpple', 2: 'banan', 3: 'körsbär'}
```

12 Exception handling

```
numbers = [1, 2, 3]
```

```
try:  
    print(numbers[5])  
except IndexError:  
    print("Index out of range")
```

- ▶ try runs the block; if an exception is raised Python jumps to except
- ▶ Code after the raising line inside try is skipped

13 Multiple exception types

```
try:
    value = int("abc")
    numbers = [1, 2, 3]
    print(numbers[5])
except ValueError:
    print("Not a valid number")
except IndexError:
    print("Index out of range")

# Catch several types in one handler
try:
    ...
except (ValueError, IndexError) as e:
    print(f"An error occurred: {e}")
```

14 Stack traces

Traceback (most recent call last):

```
File "example.py", line 10, in <module>  
    main()
```

```
File "example.py", line 7, in main  
    process_data()
```

```
File "example.py", line 4, in process_data  
    value = int("abc")
```

ValueError: invalid literal for int() with base 10: 'abc'

- ▶ The last line tells you what went wrong
- ▶ The trace shows the call chain from outermost to innermost
- ▶ Read from the bottom up — that's usually where the error is